

# PRACTICAL 2 - GLMM

In this practical we are fitting a Generalized (Mixed) Linear Model in `inlabru`.

We are going to:

- Fit a Poisson regression
- Change the prior distributions for the model hyperparameters (both for fixed and random effects)
- Compute and visualize posterior densities and summaries for marginal effects

We start by loading some useful libraries

```
library(dplyr)
library(INLA)
library(ggplot2)
library(patchwork)
library(inlabru)
library(lme4)
```

In this practical we are analysing the dataset `grouseticks`. The data, contained in the library `lme4`, consist of the number of ticks on the heads of red grouse chicks sampled in the field. See `?grouseticks` for details.

The data are analysed in the paper

Elston et al. "Analysis of aggregation, a worked example: numbers of ticks on red grouse chicks." *Parasitology*

and in this practical we follow their analysis.

```
data(grouseticks)
?grouseticks
head(grouseticks)
```

|   | INDEX | TICKS | BROOD | HEIGHT | YEAR | LOCATION | cHEIGHT   |
|---|-------|-------|-------|--------|------|----------|-----------|
| 1 | 1     | 0     | 501   | 465    | 95   | 32       | 2.759305  |
| 2 | 2     | 0     | 501   | 465    | 95   | 32       | 2.759305  |
| 3 | 3     | 0     | 502   | 472    | 95   | 36       | 9.759305  |
| 4 | 4     | 0     | 503   | 475    | 95   | 37       | 12.759305 |
| 5 | 5     | 0     | 503   | 475    | 95   | 37       | 12.759305 |
| 6 | 6     | 3     | 503   | 475    | 95   | 37       | 12.759305 |

## 0 Fitting Poisson regression

We assume that the number of ticks  $y_{ijk}$  counted on chick  $i$  of brood  $j$  in year  $k$  follows a Poisson distribution with mean  $\lambda_{ijk}$

$$y_{ijk} | \lambda_{ijk} \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda_{ijk})$$

We then model log mean counts  $\eta_{ijk} = \log(\lambda_{ijk})$  as a linear function of year, altitude, brood, and individual chick within brood. We assume a fixed effect  $\alpha_k$  of year  $k$ , a linear

effect of altitude  $x_{ij}$ , two random effects  $e_{jk}$  and  $\epsilon_{ijk}$  brood and individual within brood, respectively. Thus:

$$\eta_{ijk} = \log(\lambda_{ijk}) = \alpha_k + \beta x_{ij} + e_{jk} + \epsilon_{ijk}, \quad (1)$$

where  $e_{jk} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \tau_e^{-1})$  and  $\epsilon_{ijk} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \tau_\epsilon^{-1})$ .

We first fit the model using the default priors for fixed and random effects.

To fit the model, we first have to create two more variables, one that indexes the combination  $jk$  of brood and year and another that indexes the combination  $ijk$  of individuals per brood per year.

```
grouseticks = grouseticks %>%
  group_by(BROOD, YEAR) %>%
  mutate(ij = cur_group_id()) %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  mutate(ijk = seq_along(INDEX))
```

Now we can fit the model.

#### Task

Complete the code to fit the model in Equation 1. You need to define the components, the likelihood and finally use the `bru()` function to get the results

```
cmp= ~ -1 + year(...) +
  height(...) +
  brood_year(...) +
  brood_year_chicken(...)

lik = bru_obs(formula = ...,
              data = ...,
              family = ...)

fit = bru(cmp, lik)
```

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
cmp= ~ -1 + year(YEAR, model = "iid", initial = log(0.01), fixed = T) +
  height(cHEIGHT, model = "linear") +
  brood_year(ij, model = "iid") +
  brood_year_chicken(ijk, model= "iid")

lik = bru_obs(TICKS ~ .,
              data = grouseticks,
              family = "Poisson")

fit = bru(cmp, lik)
```

Now we can check the results.

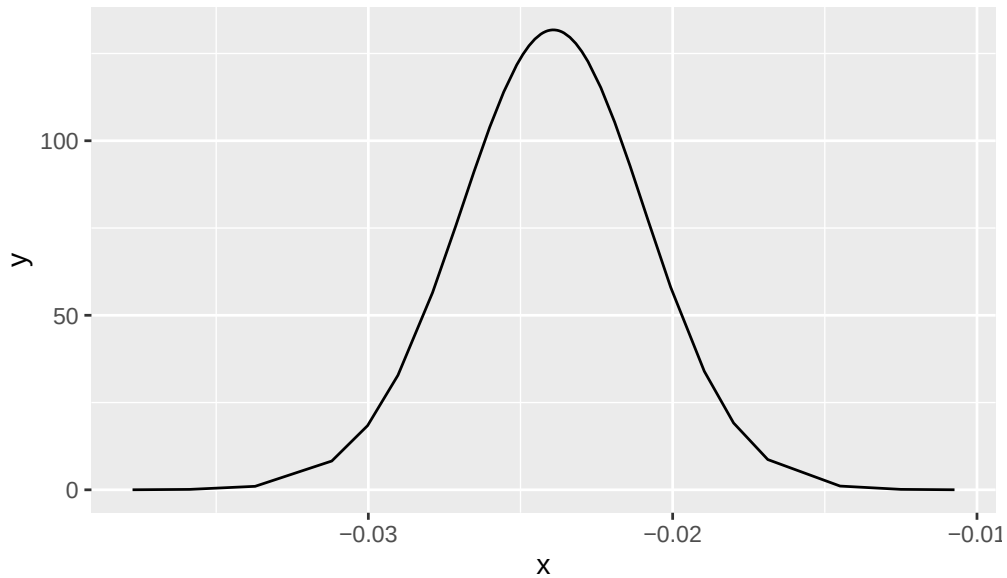
## Task

Plot the posterior distribution of the fixed effects:  $\beta$  and  $\alpha_k$ .

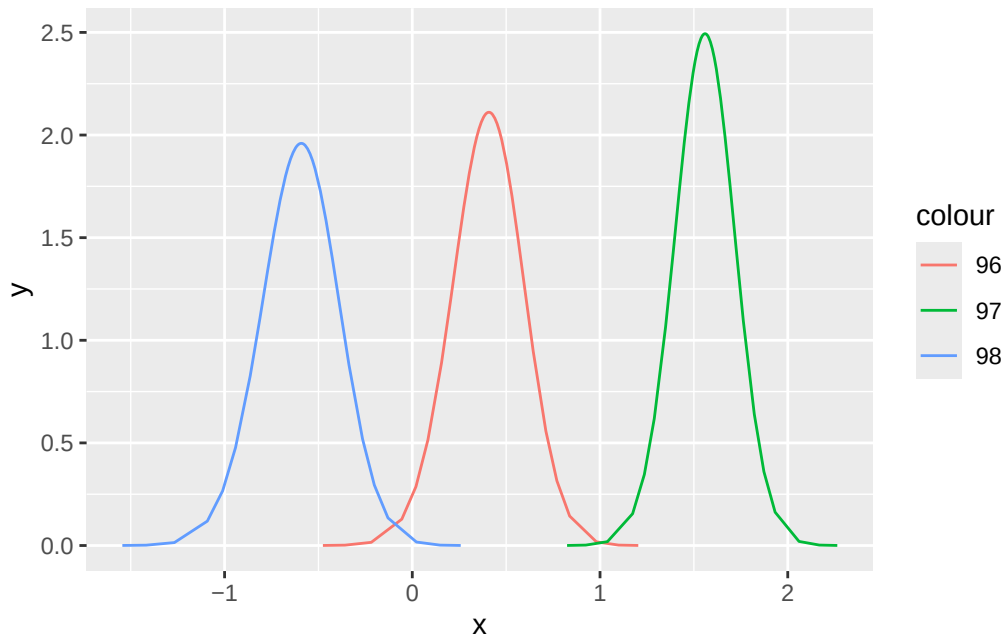
[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
fit$marginals.fixed$height %>% ggplot() + geom_line(aes(x,y)) + ggtitle("Linear effect of
```

Linear effect of altitude



```
ggplot() + geom_line(data = fit$marginals.random$year[[1]], aes(x,y, color = "96")) +  
  geom_line(data = fit$marginals.random$year[[2]], aes(x,y, color = "97")) +  
  geom_line(data = fit$marginals.random$year[[3]], aes(x,y, color = "98"))
```



We now want to look at the hyperparameters of the model.

## Task

Plot the posterior estimated of the standard deviation  $\sigma_e = \sqrt{1/\tau_e}$  and  $\sigma_\epsilon = \sqrt{1/\tau_\epsilon}$  of the two random effects.

Take hint

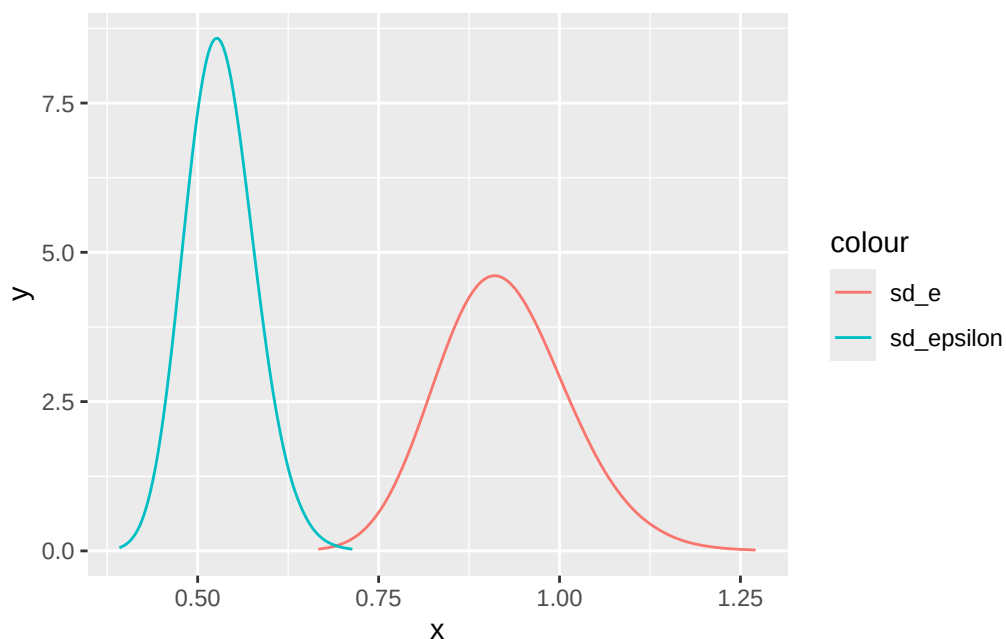
You can use the function `inla.tmarginal()` or the `generate()` function

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
# Method 1 : use the inla.tmarginal() function

sd_e = inla.tmarginal(fun = function(x)sqrt(1/x), fit$marginals.hyperpar$`Precision for brood_year`)
sd_eps = inla.tmarginal(fun = function(x)sqrt(1/x), fit$marginals.hyperpar$`Precision for year`)

ggplot() + geom_line(data = sd_e, aes(x,y, color = "sd_e")) + geom_line(data = sd_eps, aes(x,y, color = "sd_epsilon"))
```



```
# Method 1 : use the generate() function

# we use this to get the correct name of the parameters
bru_names(fit)

      height      year
"height"      "year"
  brood_year brood_year_chicken
"brood_year" "brood_year_chicken"
Precision for brood_year Precision for brood_year_chicken
"Precision_for_brood_year" "Precision_for_brood_year_chicken"
```

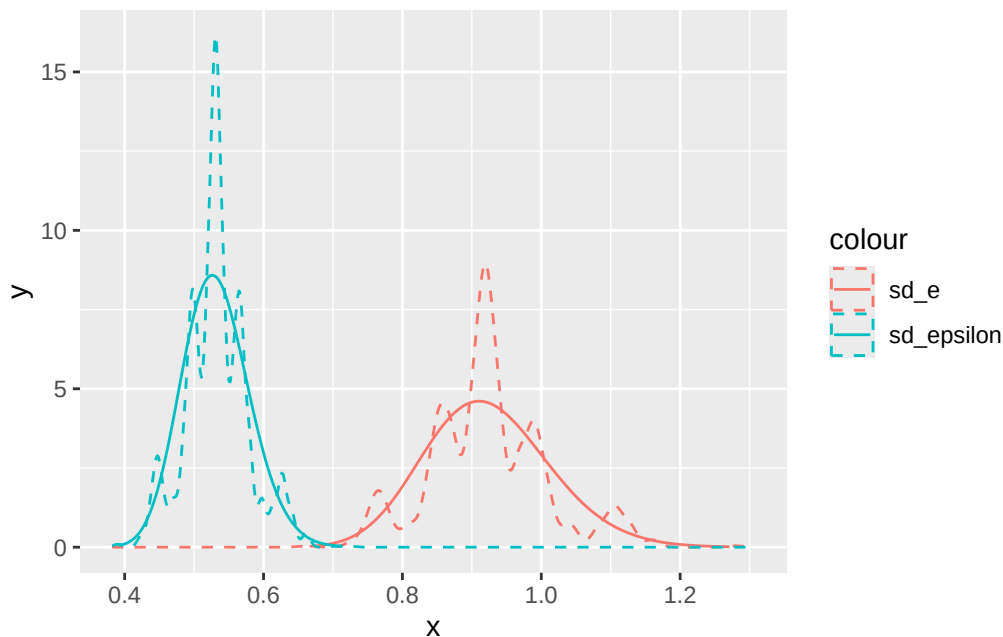
```

out = generate(fit, formula = ~ data.frame(sd_e = sqrt(1/Precision_for_brood_year),
                                           sd_eps = sqrt(1/Precision_for_brood_year_chicken)),
              n.samples = 10000)

sd_sample = data.frame(sd_e = unlist(sapply(out, function(x) x[1])),
                      sd_eps = unlist(sapply(out, function(x) x[2])))

ggplot() + geom_line(data = sd_e, aes(x,y, color = "sd_e")) +
  geom_density(data = sd_sample, aes(x = sd_e, color = "sd_e"), linetype = "dashed") +
  geom_line(data = sd_eps, aes(x,y, color = "sd_epsilon")) +
  geom_density(data = sd_sample, aes(x = sd_eps, color = "sd_epsilon"), linetype = "dashed")

```



# Note that, if one is interested in hyperparameters, sampling is not always the best choice

## 1 Change prior distributions

Before trying to change the priors for the hyperparameters we can check which priors are actually used in the model

```
inla.priors.used(fit)
```

```

section=[family]
  tag=[INLA.Data1] component=[poisson]
section=[random]
  tag=[year] component=[year]
  group.theta1:
    parameter=[logit correlation]
    prior=[normal]
    param=[0.0, 0.2]

```

```

tag=[] component=[]
tag=[brood_year] component=[brood_year]
  theta1:
    parameter=[log precision]
    prior=[loggamma]
    param=[1e+00, 5e-05]
  group.theta1:
    parameter=[logit correlation]
    prior=[normal]
    param=[0.0, 0.2]
tag=[brood_year_chicken] component=[brood_year_chicken]
  theta1:
    parameter=[log precision]
    prior=[loggamma]
    param=[1e+00, 5e-05]
  group.theta1:
    parameter=[logit correlation]
    prior=[normal]
    param=[0.0, 0.2]
section=[linear]
  tag=[height] component=[height]
    beta:
      parameter=[height]
      prior=[normal]
      param=[0.000, 0.001]

```

From the output we see that the precision for the linear effect of altitude is 0.001 (which means the sd is  $1/\sqrt{0.001} = 31.62$ )

The precisions for the random effects have a Gamma prior with parameters 1 and 5e-05.

## 1 Change the precision for the linear effects

The precision for linear effects is set in the component definition. For example, if we want to increase the precision to 0.1 for we define the respective components as:

```

cmp= ~ -1 + year(YEAR, ... ) +
  height(cHEIGHT, model = "linear", prec.linear = 0.1) + ...

```

### Task

Run the model again using 0.1 as default precision for the altitude slope parameter and for the year fixed effect

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```

cmp2 = ~ -1 + year(YEAR, model = "iid", initial = log(0.1), fixed = T) +
  height(cHEIGHT, model = "linear", prec.linear = 0.1) +
  brood_year(ij , model = "iid") +
  brood_year_chicken(ijk, model= "iid")

fit2 = bru(cmp2, lik)

```

Note that we can use the same observation model as before since both the formula and the dataset are unchanged.

### Changing the precision for the random effects

Priors on the hyperparameters of the random effects model must be passed by defining argument `hyper` within component of interest

```
# First we define the logGamma (0.01,0.01) prior

prec.prior <- list(prec = list(prior = "loggamma", # prior name
                              param = c(0.01, 0.01))) # prior parameters

cmp3 = ~ -1 + year(YEAR, model = "iid", initial = log(0.1), fixed = T) +
  height(cHEIGHT, model = "linear", prec.linear = 0.1) +
  brood_year(ij , model = "iid", hyper = prec.prior) +
  brood_year_chicken(ijk, model= "iid", hyper = prec.prior)

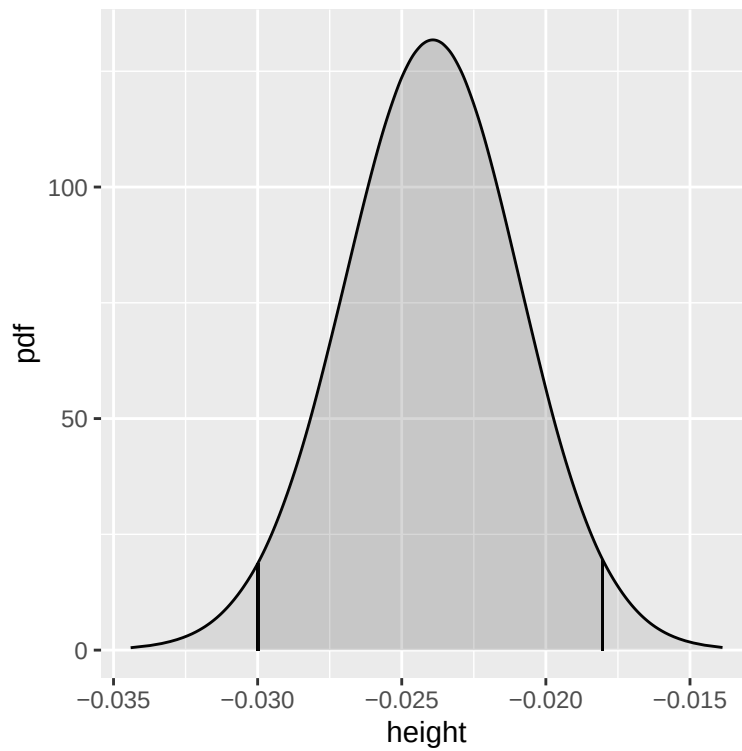
fit3 = bru(cmp3, lik)
```

Note that for `model = "linear"` the value for the precision is expressed in natural scale while for `model = "iid"` (and all other random effects) the value is expressed in log scale.

#### 1.1.1 Visualizing the posterior marginals

Posterior marginal distributions of the fixed effects parameters and the hyperparameters can be visualized also using the `plot()` function by calling the name of the component. For example, if want to visualize the posterior density of the slope  $\beta$  we can type:

```
plot(fit, "height")
```



### Task

Plot the posterior marginals for the precision of brood and individual random effect  $\pi(\tau_e|y)$

Take hint

See the `summary()` output to check the names for the different model components.  
[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
plot(fit, "Precision for brood_year")
```

